



Every brand makes promises. And by living up to its promises the brand can earn user trust. This third Digit Icons of Trust survey looks at how popular technology brands are perceived by users who have had the opportunity to assess and experience these brand promises.

Team Digit

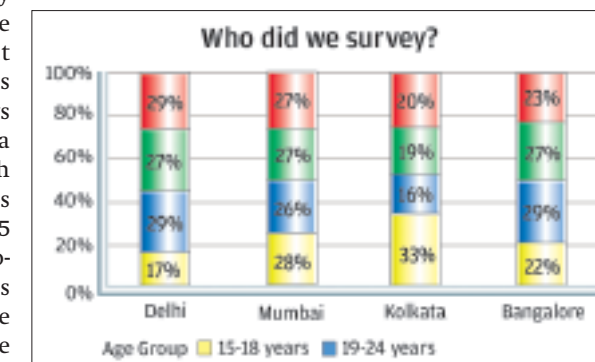
The marketplace for technology products is replete with hundreds of brands competing for buyer attention. Just what is it that makes you select one brand over another? Do you choose a brand because you believe it delivers better technical features, or do you go by its reputation for superb design? How satisfied are you with the brands you have bought? Would you consider repurchasing products of the same brand, or recommending it to others? To get answers to questions like these, and to find out what users thought about technology brands we commissioned a survey.

We asked one of India's leading market research agencies to contact technology products users across the nation, and find out what they thought about various brands. Structured interviews were conducted using a detailed questionnaire with selected respondents (males in the age group of 15 to 45 years in specified socio-economic groups) across Mumbai, Delhi, Bangalore and Kolkata. People whose opinions were sought were all

identified as decision makers (or influencers) in the purchase of any of the following products: cellphones, desktop PCs, digital cameras, monitors, external storage devices, laptops, MP3 players, printers, and multi-function devices. All these interactions were conducted in early September 2008.

The Digit survey measured user attitudes and perceptions about brands, including brand awareness, loyalty, cost of ownership, satisfaction and credibility. The research agency analysed the collected data, using rigorous statistical techniques, to synthesise a composite "Index of Trust" for every product category. For all the nine product categories, brands were individually scored on the Index of Trust. These scores reflect the overall attitude and perception of users and customers towards that brand on various dimensions of the brand promise, based on actual ownership and experience.

The condensed results of Digit's Icons of Trust survey, which are presented over the next few pages, will not only enable users to confirm which brands they can rely on, but also allow product vendors to improve the brand experience for all their customers.



The Indices Of Trust

Since trust is an abstract concept, the definition can vary depending on who you ask. For this survey we defined "trust" as a composite of the following factors: awareness, loyalty, satisfaction, credibility, and cost of ownership.

- To measure brand awareness, we captured top-of-mind recall, un-prompted recall, and aided recall of brand names amongst respondents.
- Loyalty for a brand was ascertained by administering a series of questions that looked at respondents' willingness to talk positively about the brand to others, recom-

mend the brand, and to repurchase products.

- We asked users about warranty periods, number of times the product broke down, the time and cost involved in getting the product repaired or serviced to determine the cost of ownership.
- To measure satisfaction and the quality of user experience with the brand we asked respondents to comment on attributes like product availability, pre- and post-sales support, and value for money.
- Brand credibility was measured by using a series of statements that asked users about issues such as product quality, durability, style and design, innovativeness, and features.

The mean score for every statement was calculated for the entire respondent base, and the various indices (viz., Credibility Index, Satisfaction Index, Loyalty Index, Ownership Index, and Awareness Index) were computed by multiplying the category coefficients with the mean scores.

For calculating the Index of Trust, we had to first determine impact of each factor on overall trust. To do this, we used multiple regression techniques. This enabled us determine the relative contribution of each factor to the Trust Index. Each of the indices was then multiplied by its respective coefficient (obtained from the regression model) to calculate the "Trust Index" score for every brand.

